

The Swinging Door

Thursday, September 3, 2026

OPINION & PERSPECTIVE

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THE EDITORIAL PAGE

Where the headlines meet the household.

The numbers make the news. What we make of them is another story.

The price of paying attention

From the editor's desk

A financial headline can travel halfway around the world before it reaches the kitchen table. By then, it has acquired a different unit of measurement: a monthly payment, an insurance renewal or the price on a familiar menu.

That is where this page begins. The economy is more than a chart on a screen. It is also the small calculation before a decision and the conversation that follows it.

In Naples, there is room for a financial cartoon that recognizes those conversations without turning every reader into an analyst. A good drawing needs an observation. A good caption leaves something for the reader to discover.

A smaller stage

The Swinging Door gives that conversation a room of its own. Drew supplies the dry observation. Barclay brings the bill back to human scale. Abby has heard enough of both to know when the discussion is over.

The bar is a setting for the joke, not its subject. The subject is the distance between an announcement and the ordinary day it eventually reaches.

There is no need to shout across that distance. Sometimes the quietest sentence carries furthest.

The Swinging Door

AN EDITORIAL CARTOON



Barclay: "I don't mind a rate hike. I'd just like two years of waiting for a cut counted as time served."

THE SWINGING DOOR / ARCHIVE ARTWORK A01

"The conversation is local.
The absurdity travels."

AROUND THE TABLE

A number is only the beginning

A house can have a market value, an assessed value and a taxable value. An insurance quote can look simple until the coverage is compared. A familiar asking price can imply an unfamiliar payment.

Those distinctions are worth explaining. They are also fertile ground for a cartoon, provided the joke rests on the difference itself and not on somebody's misfortune.

What earns a place here

A specific observation. A clear visual scene. Characters with different ways of seeing the same piece of news. A line short enough to read once and interesting enough to read again.

The point is recognition: that slight pause when a reader realizes the person at the next stool has been doing the same arithmetic.

Three seats. One conversation.

Drew
The measured observer.

Barclay
The number on the receipt.

Abby
The last word, when needed.